From Tokenized Assets to Tokenized Markets

Liquidity, Distribution, and the Next Phase of RWA

Danning Sui

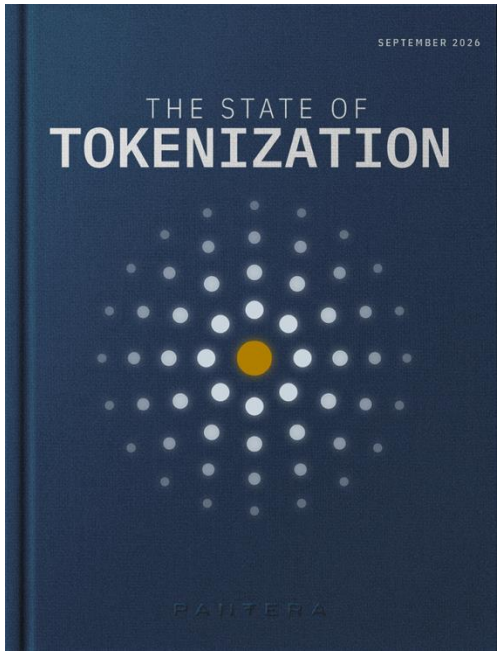
Research Director, Pantera Capital

Pantera’s tokenization research



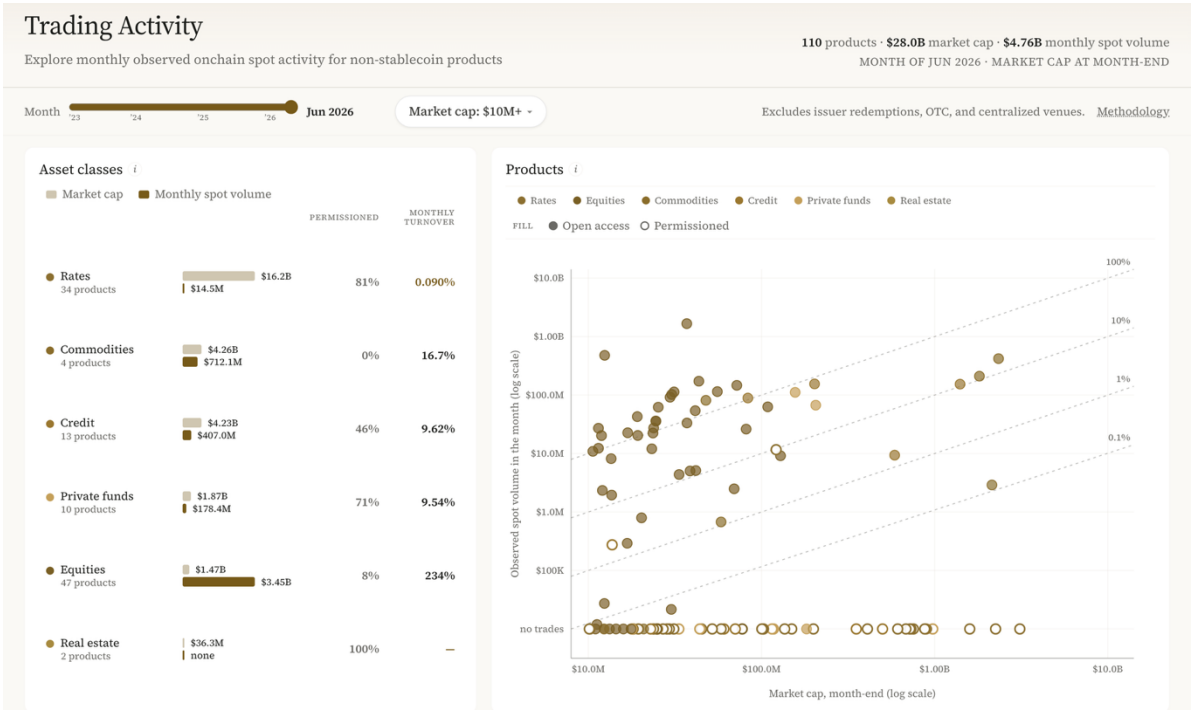
Q1 2026

Framework and catalog



September 2026

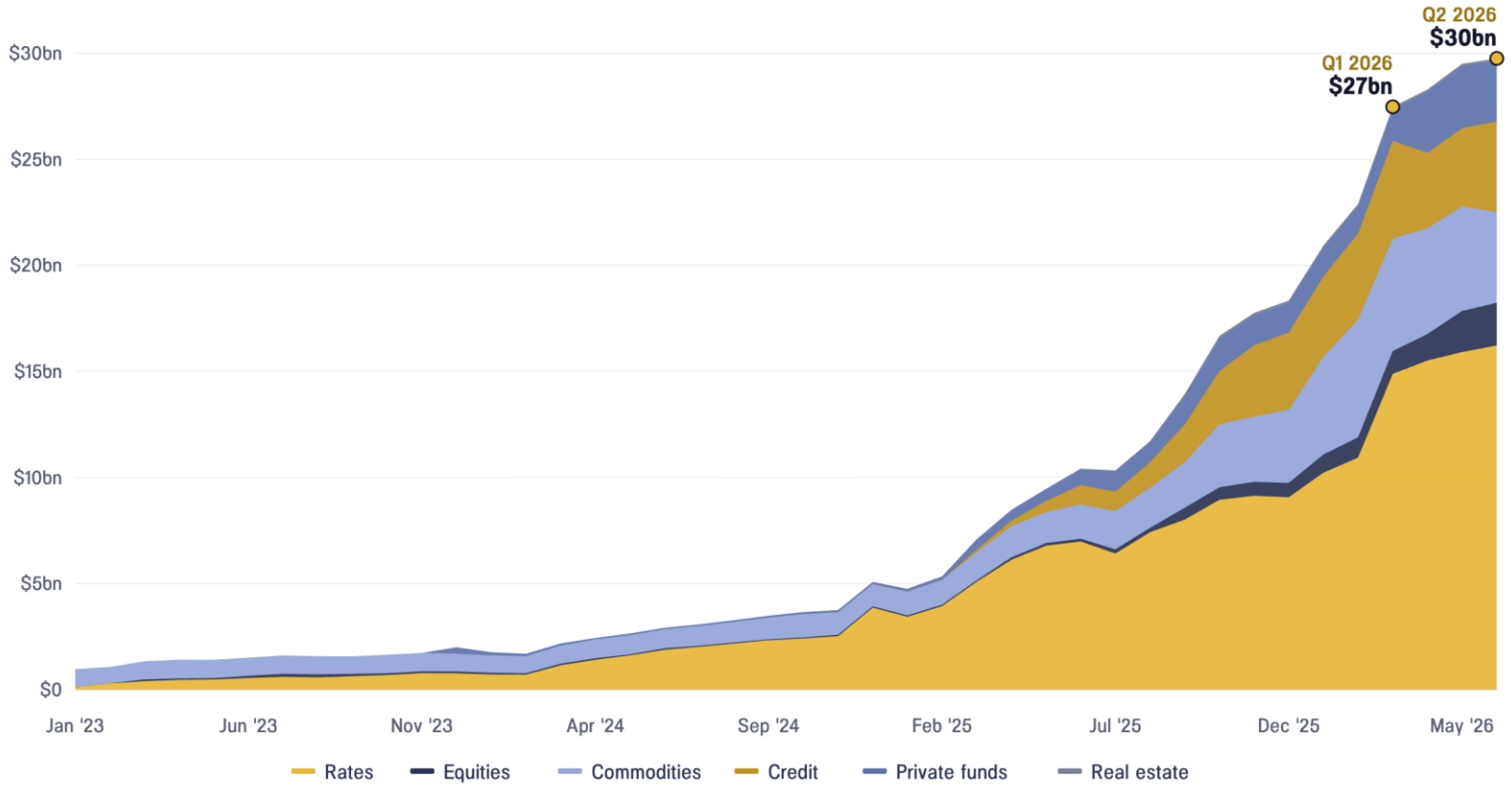
Market activity and access



Data portal: tokenization.panteracapital.com

RWA metadata, trading activity and more

The RWA market at H1 close



$331.8bn

market benchmark

–2.3%

stablecoin value

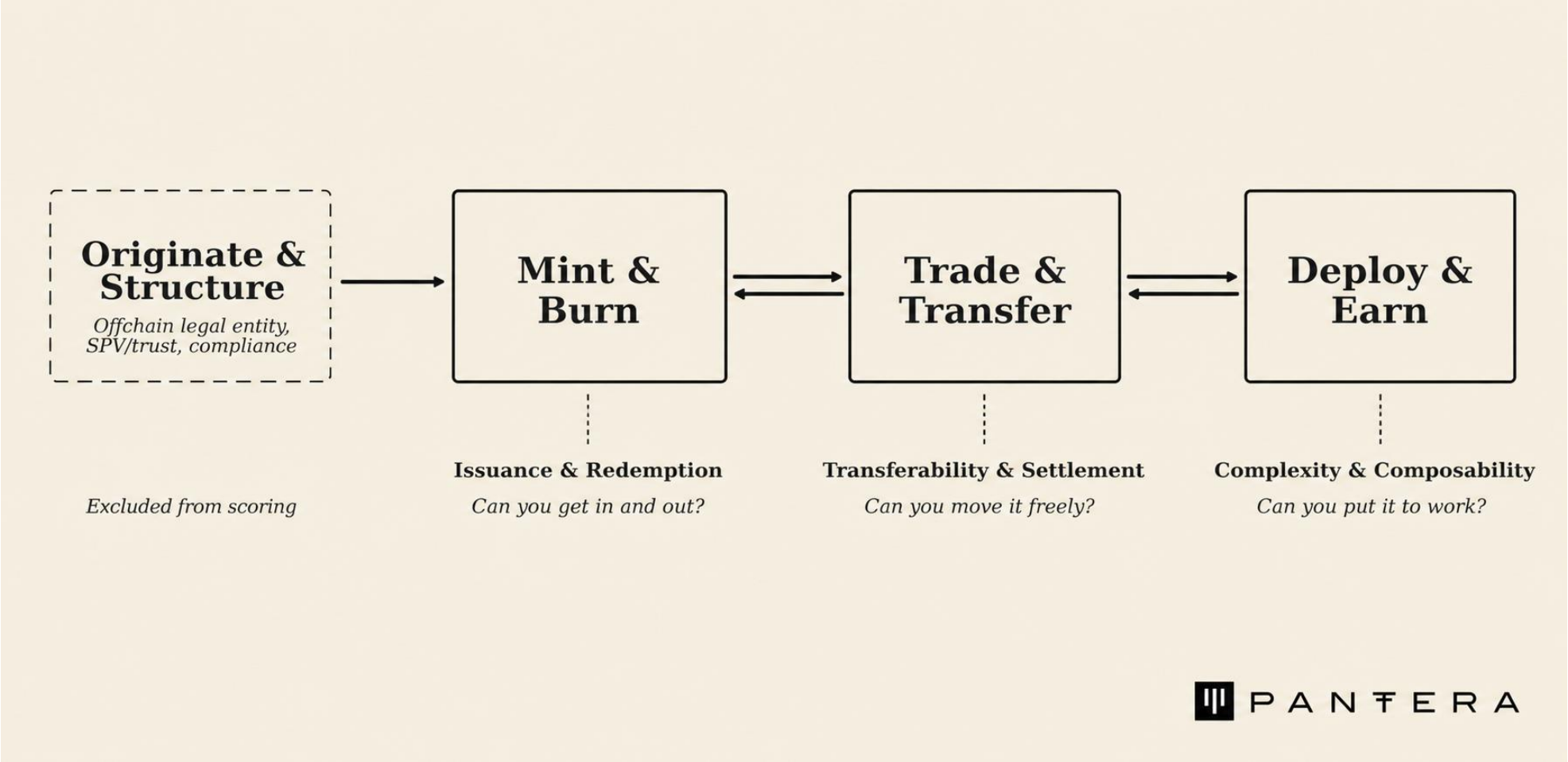
+13.3%

non-stablecoin value

Historical Allium series: separate coverage universe. Band split is stylized in the source.

Source: September report pp. 27–30. Market benchmark: RWA.xyz, March 25–June 30, 2026.

The RWA lifecycle and three scored on-chain stages



Source: Q1 2026 report, p. 11. Legal origination is outside the TPI score.

TPI rubric: Issuance & Redemption

Score	Archetype	Description
1	Gated Wrapper	Admin-only mint. Non-redeemable or manual OTC via issuer. Maximum asymmetry.
2	Custodian-Mediated	Admin mint with compliance hooks. Redemption via custodian, T+1 to T+7.
3	Semi-Autonomous	Automated mint with collateral checks. Holder-initiated redemption with gate.
4	Autonomous	Autonomous collateral-verified mint. On-chain burn with minimal delay. Near-symmetric.
5	Fully Symmetric	Permissionless mint AND burn. Any holder, any time, zero intermediary.

Source: Q1 2026 report, p. 12. Full five-level rubric.

TPI rubric: Transferability & Settlement

Score	Archetype	Description
1	Off-Chain Only	Non-transferable on-chain or issuer-only OTC. No secondary market. Off-chain ledger is sole record.
2	Off-Chain Primary	Whitelist-gated transfers. Off-chain ledger authoritative, on-chain mirrors. Limited OTC secondary.
3	Dual-Ledger Synced	Off-chain and on-chain co-exist, reconciled periodically. Functional secondary market.
4	On-Chain Primary	On-chain ledger is the primary record. Off-chain for compliance only. Active secondary. Atomic settlement.
5	On-Chain Sovereign	On-chain is the sole source of truth. No off-chain ledger. Permissionless, deep liquidity. Transfer IS settlement.

Source: Q1 2026 report, p. 12. Full five-level rubric.

TPI rubric: Complexity & Composability

Score	Archetype	Description
1	Platform-Captive	Issuer contract only. No self-custody. No DeFi. Minimal smart contract logic. Database entry.
2	Basic custody	User wallet but admin freeze/pause. Simple mint/burn logic. Limited autonomous behavior.
3	Gated composability	Self-custody with whitelist. 1–2 DeFi protocols. Oracle integration, basic governance.
4	Open composability	Full self-custody. Major lending protocols. Complex multi-contract with liquidation, risk params.
5	Sovereign composability	Permissionless. Deep multi-protocol, cross-chain. Autonomous risk engine, liquidation, governance.

Source: Q1 2026 report, p. 12. Full five-level rubric.

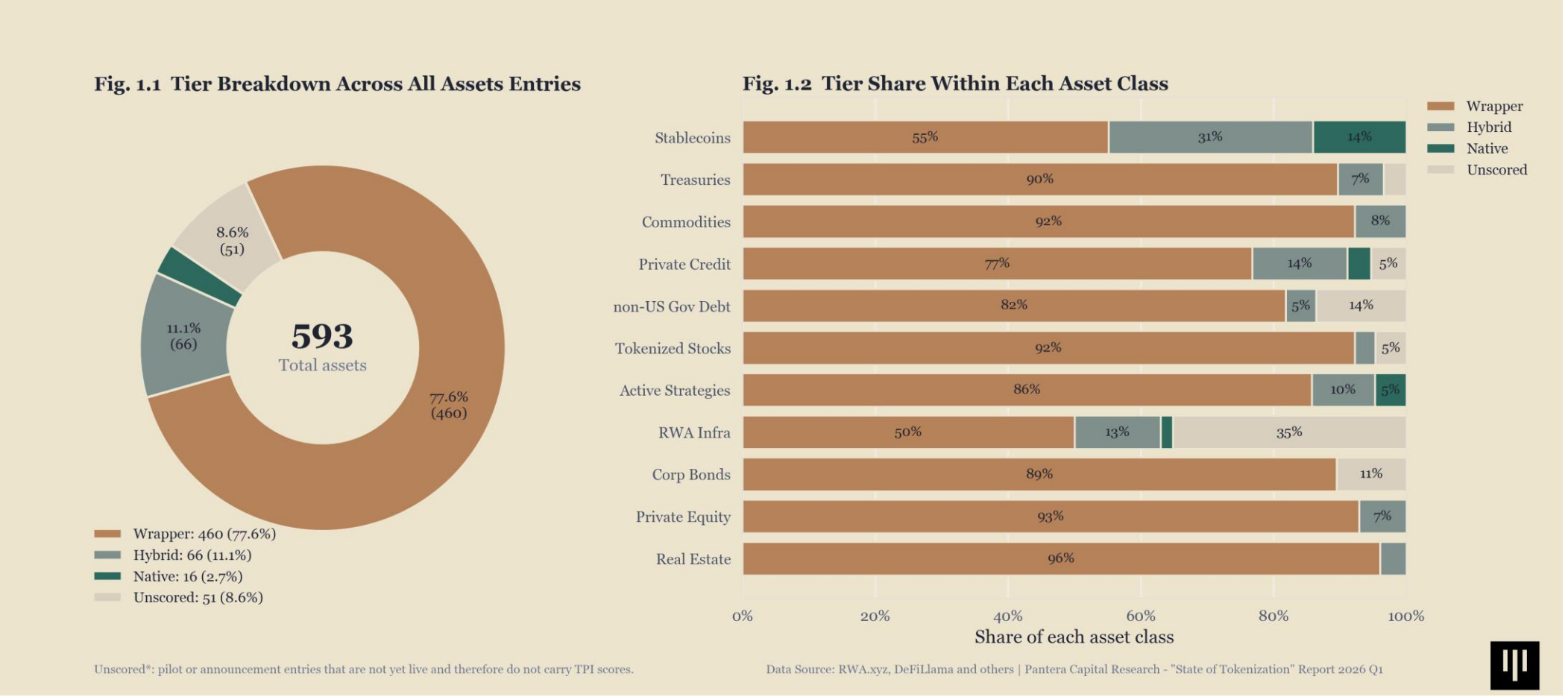
TPI composite and product tiers

Composite = average of the three scores, each from 1 to 5

Tier	Composite score	Operating model
Wrapper	≤ 2.5	Tokenized claim on an off-chain asset. Custody and the authoritative ledger remain off-chain.
Hybrid	> 2.5 and < 3.5	Some lifecycle stages run on-chain. Critical custody or redemption dependencies remain off-chain.
Native	≥ 3.5	Primarily governed by smart contracts, with minimal off-chain dependencies.

Source: Q1 2026 report, pp. 11–13. TPI measures structural and operational maturity.

State of the Market (Q1): wrappers dominated the asset catalog



Source: Q1 2026 report, p. 16, Figure 1. Catalog: 593 products, including 51 unscored.

More products, little change in incumbent TPI

Product tier	Q1 catalog	H1 catalog	Examples from the reports
Wrapper	460	506	BlackRock BUIDL; JMWH
Hybrid	66	72	USDC; Franklin BENJI
Native	16	20	MakerDAO USDS; Aave GHO
Unscored	51	73	Pilot or announced products
All tracked products	593	671	Examples are illustrative, not a size ranking

2.04 / 5

average TPI in both editions

501 / 515

matched products kept the same score

Sources: Q1 pp. 4, 13 and 29; September pp. 25–26 and 31. Examples follow the reports' classifications.

September Report:
From Tokenized Assets to Tokenized Markets

1. Liquidity

- Observed spot volume and turnover
- Transfer permissions and asset class
- Spot exit capacity

2. Distribution

- Deployment across chains
- Holder-address breadth
- Balance concentration

3. Utilization

- Capital supplied against RWA collateral
- DeFi TVL relative to represented value

4. Access rails

- Perpetual markets and price exposure
- Consumer distribution through Robinhood

Source: September report, pp. 6–24 and 32. Each lens uses its stated population, period and coverage.

1. Liquidity Metrics: spot trading versus token transfers

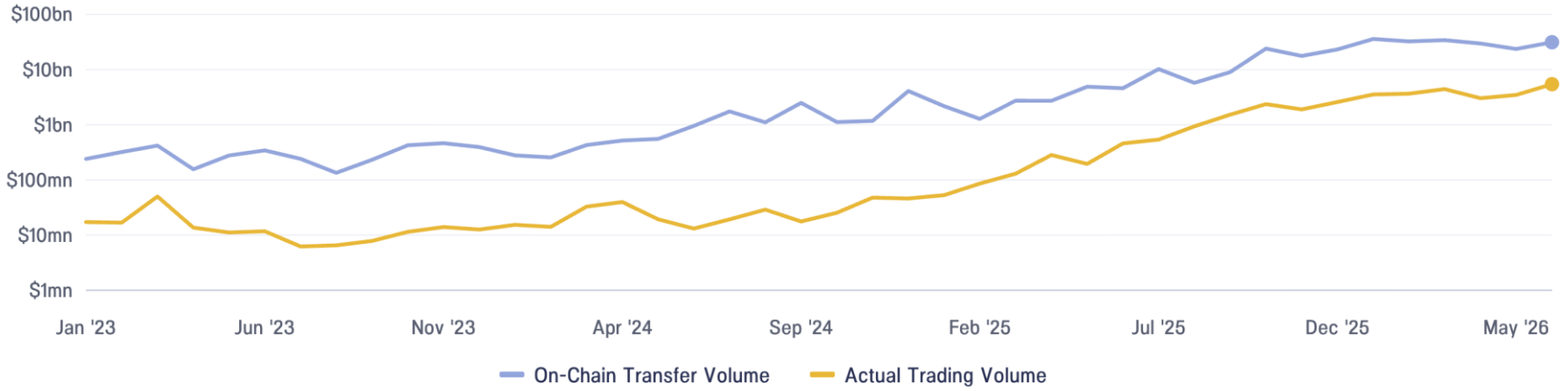
Observed spot trading

Once-counted trades on DEXs and RWA-native on-chain platforms.

Token transfers

Trades plus operational flows such as subscriptions, redemptions and custody moves.

Coverage excludes centralized exchange books, OTC, ATS and broker execution.



June spot turnover: Rates 0.1% / Equities 204.6%

Source: September pp. 9–10, 19 and 38. Turnover = full-month observed spot volume / month-end market cap.

Access taxonomy: restrictions on the token’s transfer

Classification follows who may receive the token after issuance.

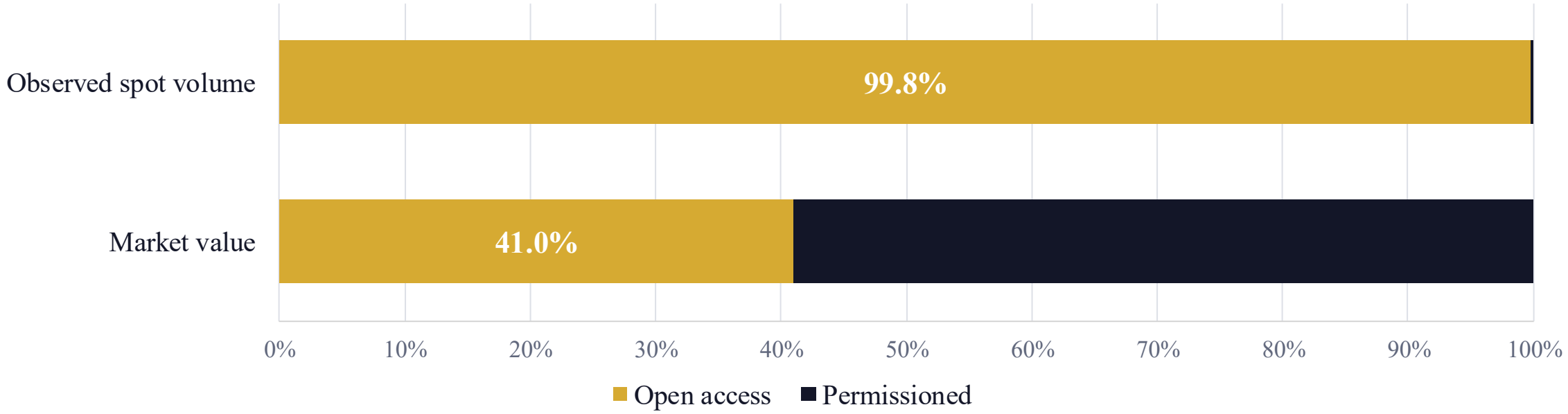
Transfer regime	Definition in the September report	June cohort
Open access	No transfer-level identity or address restriction. Any address can receive and trade the token.	59 products
Permissioned: whitelist-only	A transfer settles only between addresses the issuer or its transfer agent has approved. Venue pool and settlement addresses also need approval.	48 products
Permissioned: accredited-only	Open only to verified accredited investors. The eligibility restriction gates transfer.	3 products

Primary issuance and redemption are a separate layer

Open-access transfers can coexist with KYC at minting or redemption.
Nearly every product in the cohort vets investors at subscription.

Source: September p. 8. Definitions arranged from the report’s prose. June 30, 2026; most restrictive deployment rule.

41% of value generated 99.8% of observed trading

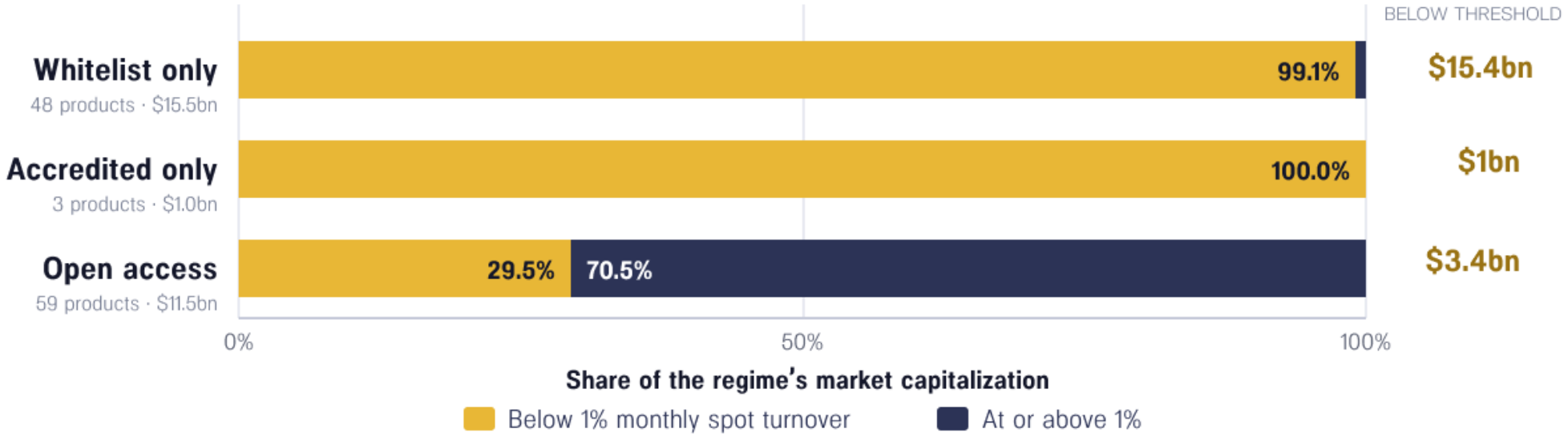


Permissioned share: 59% of value, 0.2% of spot trading

Access and product purpose overlap. This comparison does not isolate causality.

June 2026: 110 non-stablecoin products ≥ $10mn. Transfer-based taxonomy. Source: September pp. 6–8.

46 of 48 whitelist-only products had low turnover



99.1%

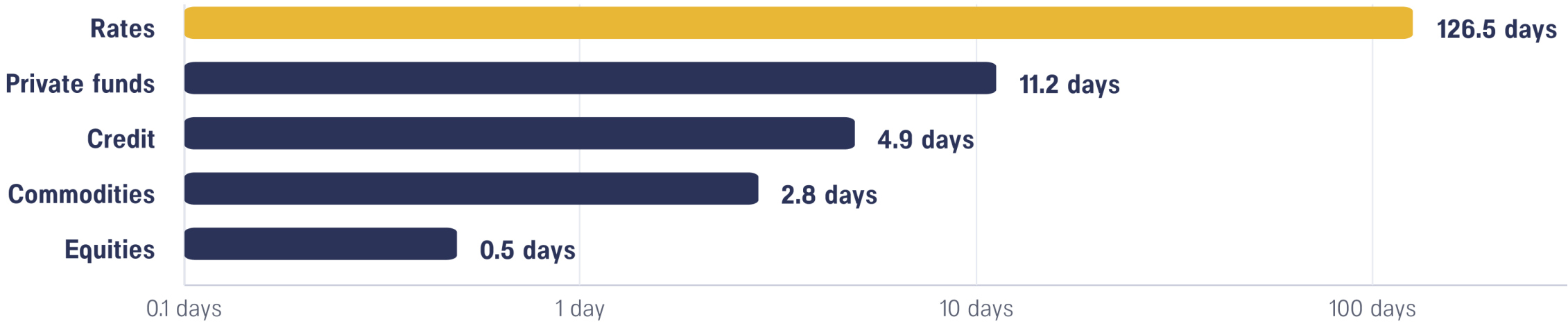
of whitelist-only value below 1% turnover

29.5%

of open-access value also below 1%

Source: September p. 15, Figure 8. Same transfer regimes and 110-product June cohort.

Liquidity Metric 3: Spot exit capacity for issuer redemption



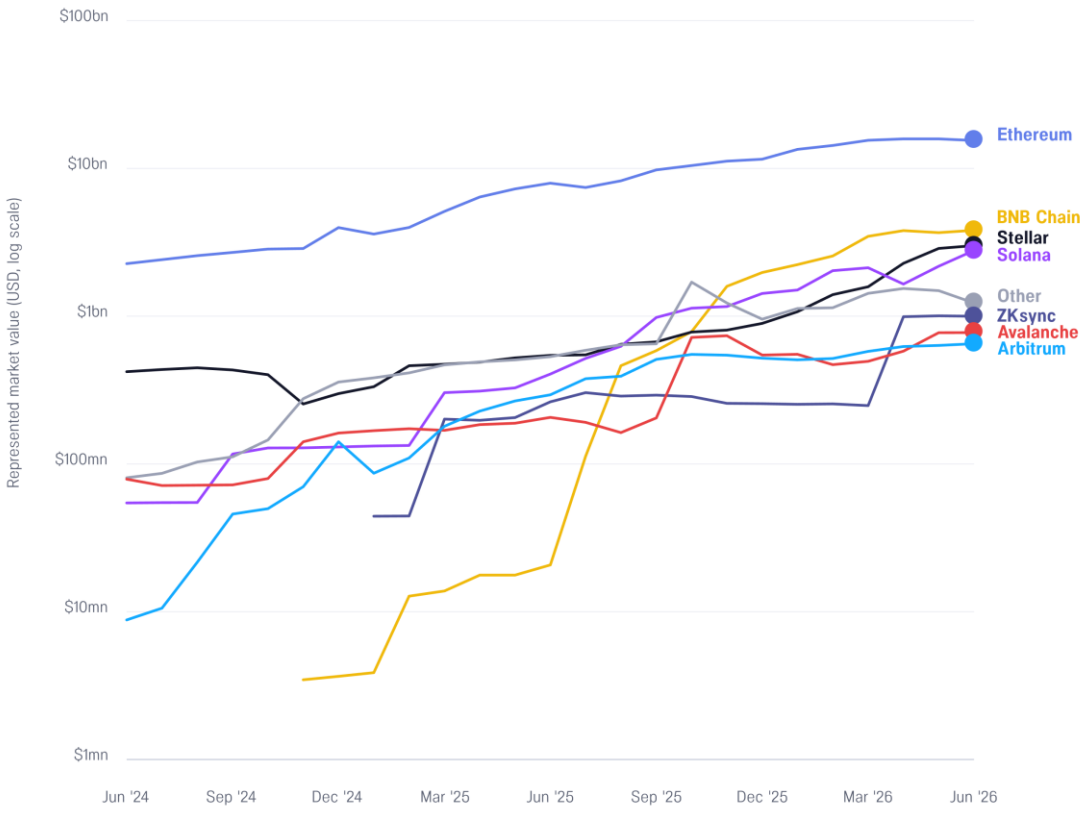
$10mn sale at 15% of aggregate class daily spot volume

Excludes issuer redemptions. Does not estimate price impact or guarantee execution.

Source: September report p. 10, Figure 3. Illustrative class-level participation benchmark, June 2026.

2. Distribution: deployment, breadth and concentration

Non-stablecoin value by chain (USD, log scale)



Deployment

Chains and share of market value
3 to 23 chains; Ethereum 53.8%

Holder breadth

Distinct holder addresses per product.
Aggregates count product × chain balance positions.

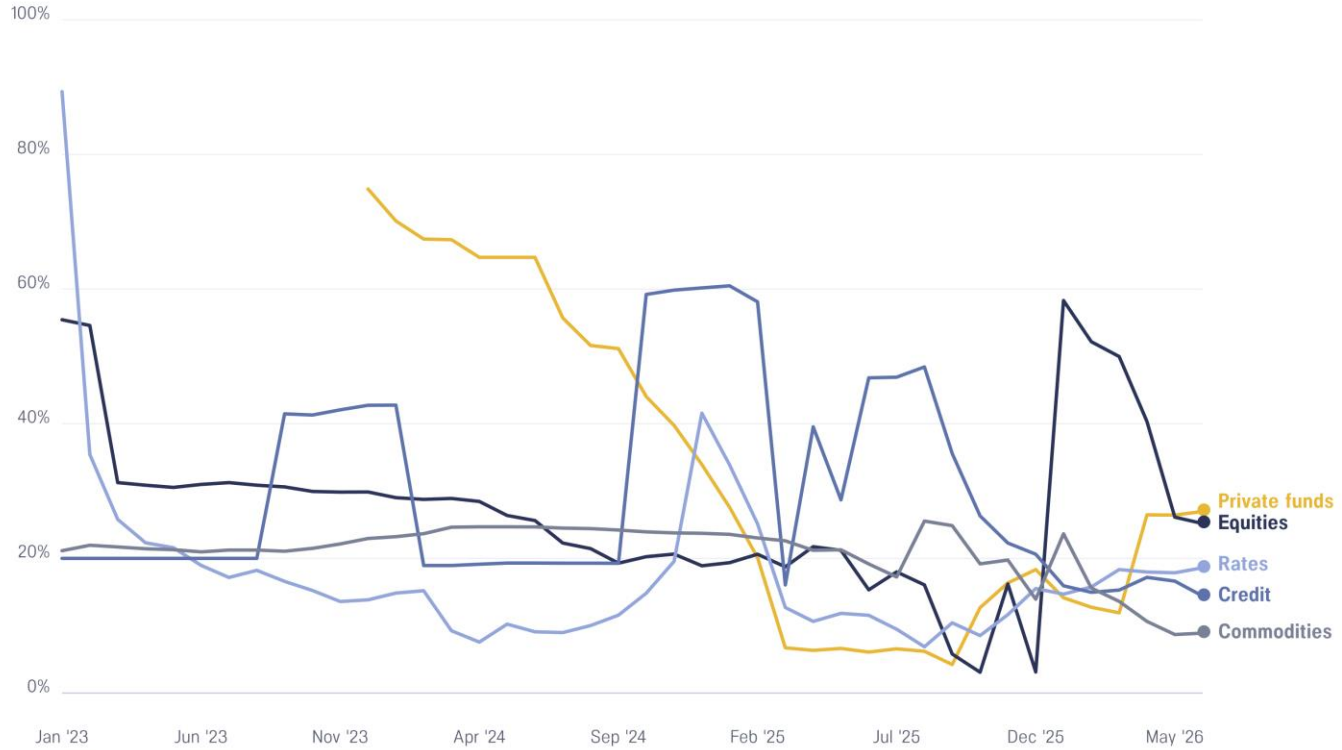
Balance concentration

Largest position / class value.
Top-ten share within each product.

Source: September pp. 11–13. Chart: selected chains, Jun. 2024–Jun. 2026. Addresses and positions are not unique people.

Distribution: class concentration and product holdings

Largest reported position / total class market cap



Separate product-level metric

Top-ten share of supply

93.0%

Syrup USDT
1,105 holder addresses

32.5%

PAX Gold
91,775 holder addresses

A class-level share can fall as the class grows, even if existing products stay concentrated.

Source: September pp. 12–13, Figure 6. Balances measure address concentration, not identified beneficial ownership.

Liquidity × distribution: a 110-product matrix

June subset: non-stablecoin products ≥ $10mn, using observed on-chain trading and balances.

Distribution screen: ≥1,000 holder addresses and top-ten share ≤90%

Spot turnover ≥1%

29 products

$6.6bn / 23.5% of value

Distribution screen: pass

All open-access

18 products

$1.7bn / 5.9% of value

Distribution screen: fail

Syrup USDT, Hastra PRIME

Spot turnover <1%

6 products

$4.6bn / 16.5% of value

Distribution screen: pass

USDY, Spiko, BENJI

57 products

$15.2bn / 54.1% of value

Distribution screen: fail

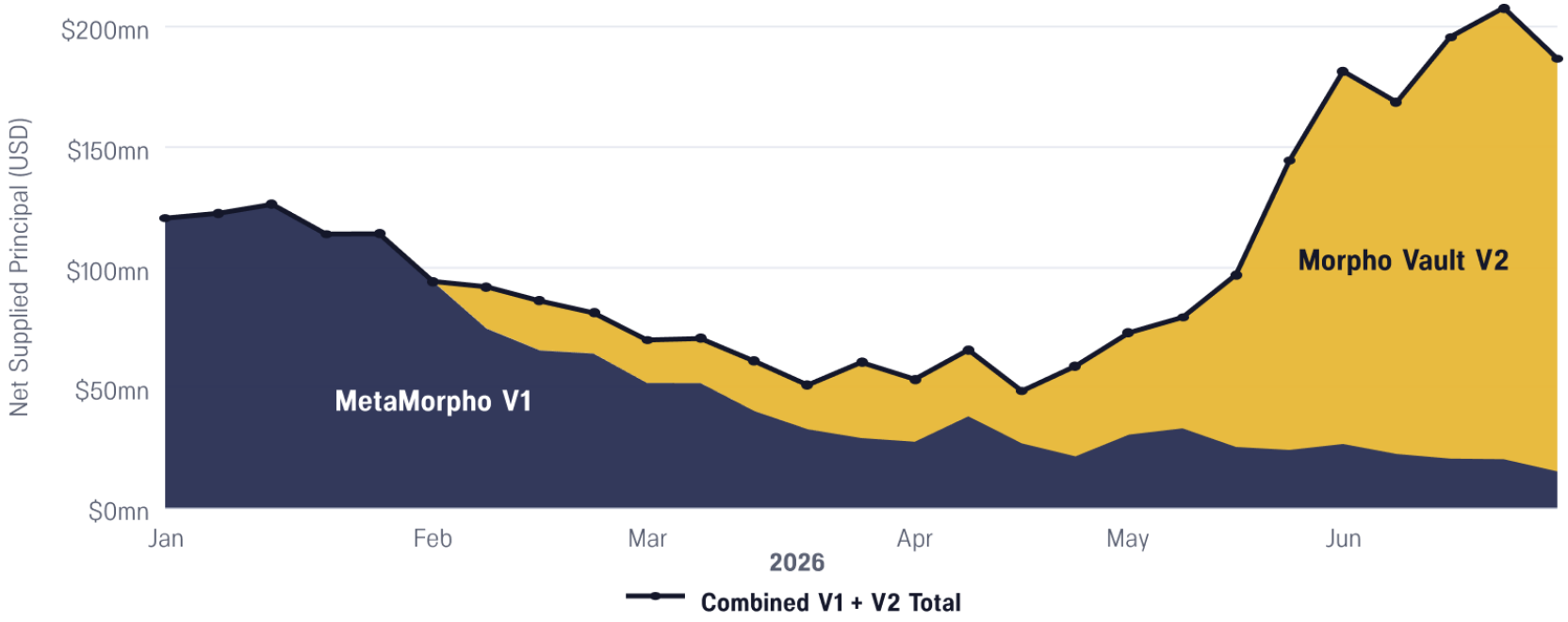
BUIDL, USYC, iBENJI

Source: September pp. 13–15 and 38. Includes zero/low observed turnover. Screens do not measure executable depth or issuer redemption.

3. On-chain utilization: RWA collateral on Morpho

Economic use through lending and collateral

Morpho measure: cumulative deposits minus withdrawals, floored at zero.



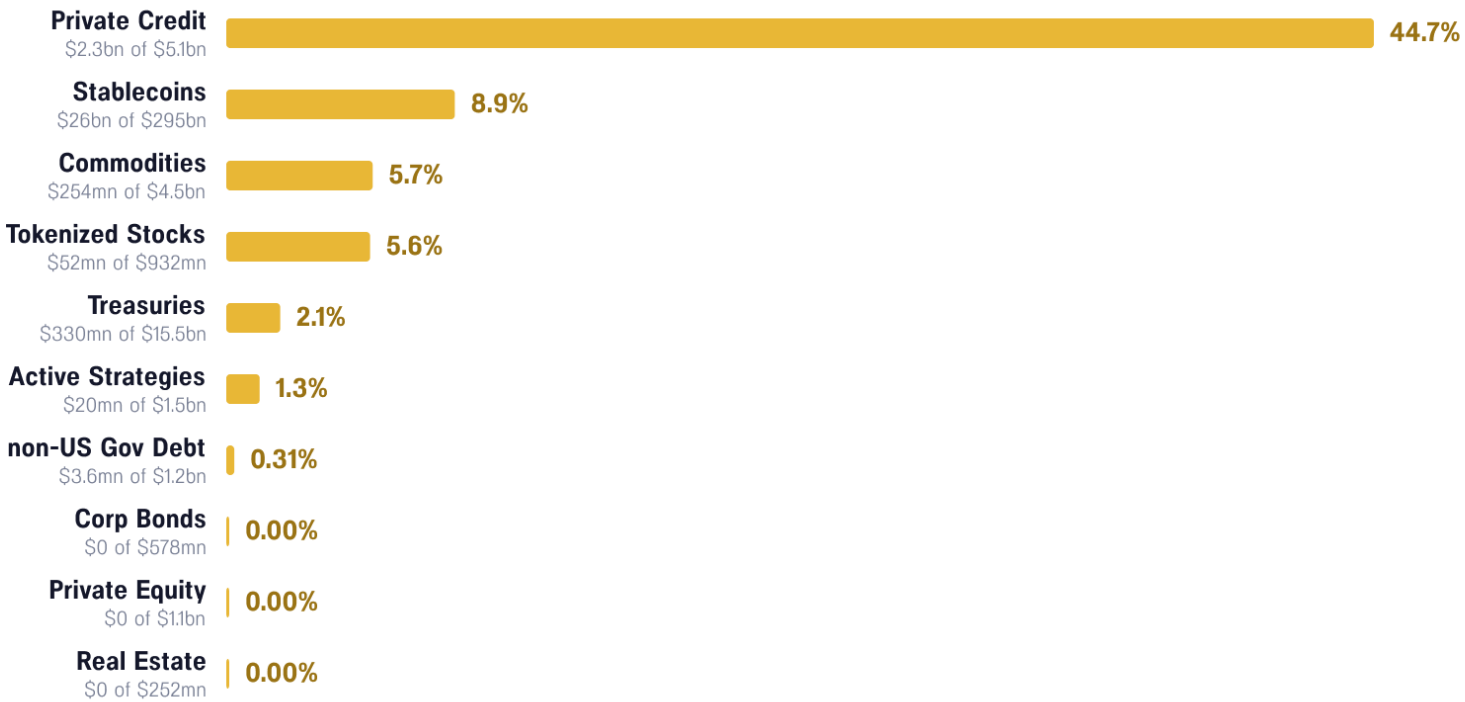
$187mn net capital supplied at H1 close

92% through Vault V2

Source: September pp. 16–17, Figure 9. Traceable RWA collateral markets; net supplied capital is a cash-flow proxy, not holdings or TVL.

DeFi utilization: private credit has a distinct use case

Utilization = DeFi TVL / represented value of the same included products



44.7%

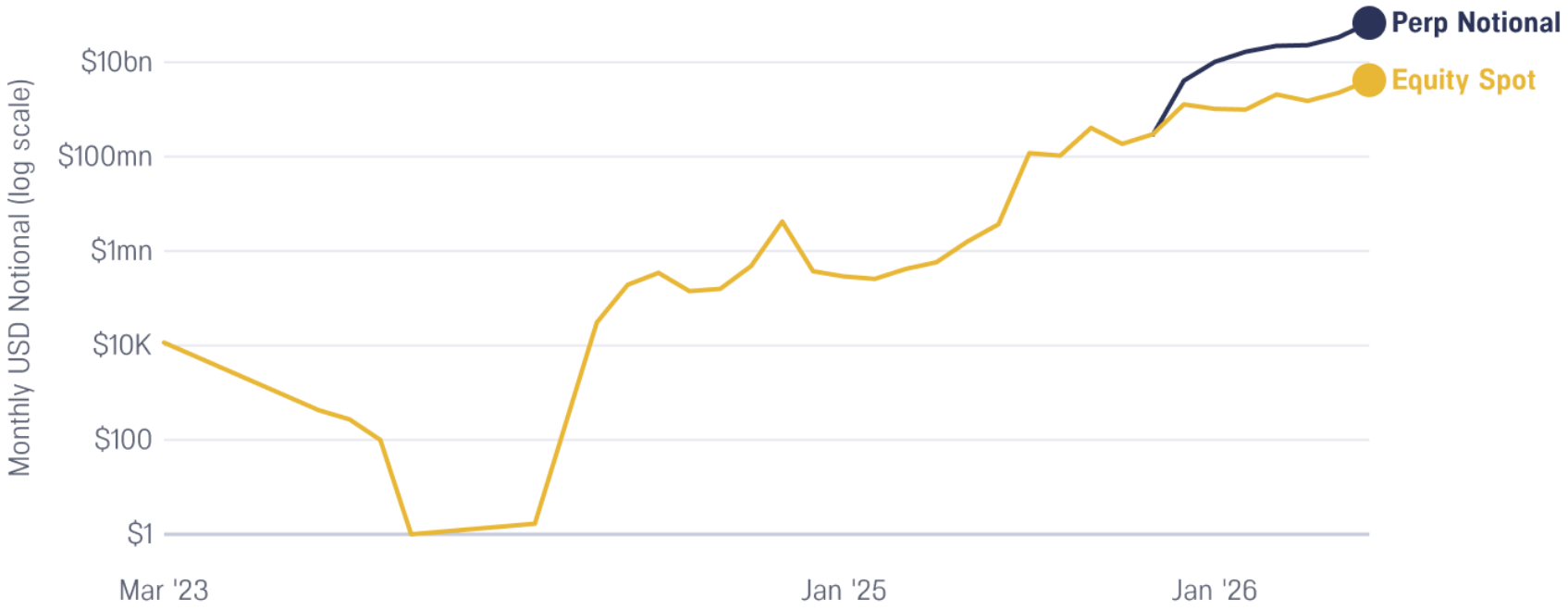
private-credit utilization in matched coverage

Early-Q3 TVL snapshot versus H1-end values

Collateral still needs a workable exit in stress.

Source: September p. 32. Matched product coverage; this ratio measures DeFi use, not all-market adoption or spot turnover.

4. Access rails: equity perpetual volume was 16× spot



$67.8bn

equity-perpetual notional

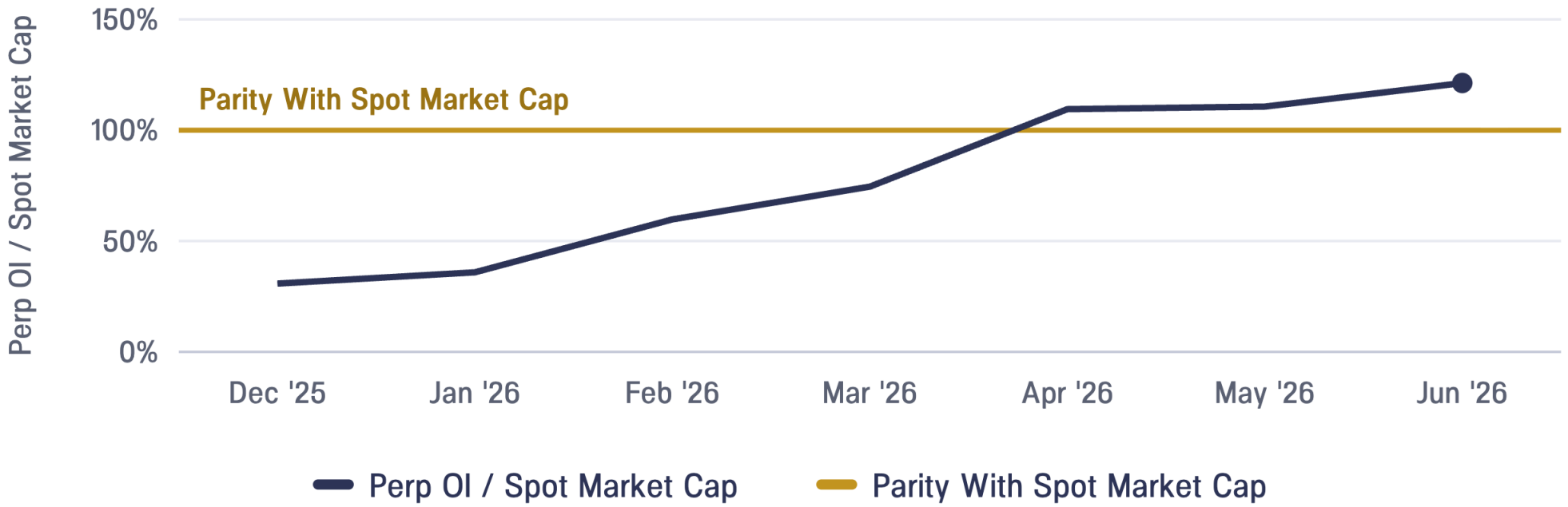
$4.2bn

observed tokenized-equity spot

Leveraged notional measures demand for exposure, not equivalent invested capital.

Source: September p. 19. June 2026 equity perpetuals on Hyperliquid + Lighter versus observed tokenized-equity spot.

Hyperliquid equity-perp open interest exceeded spot value

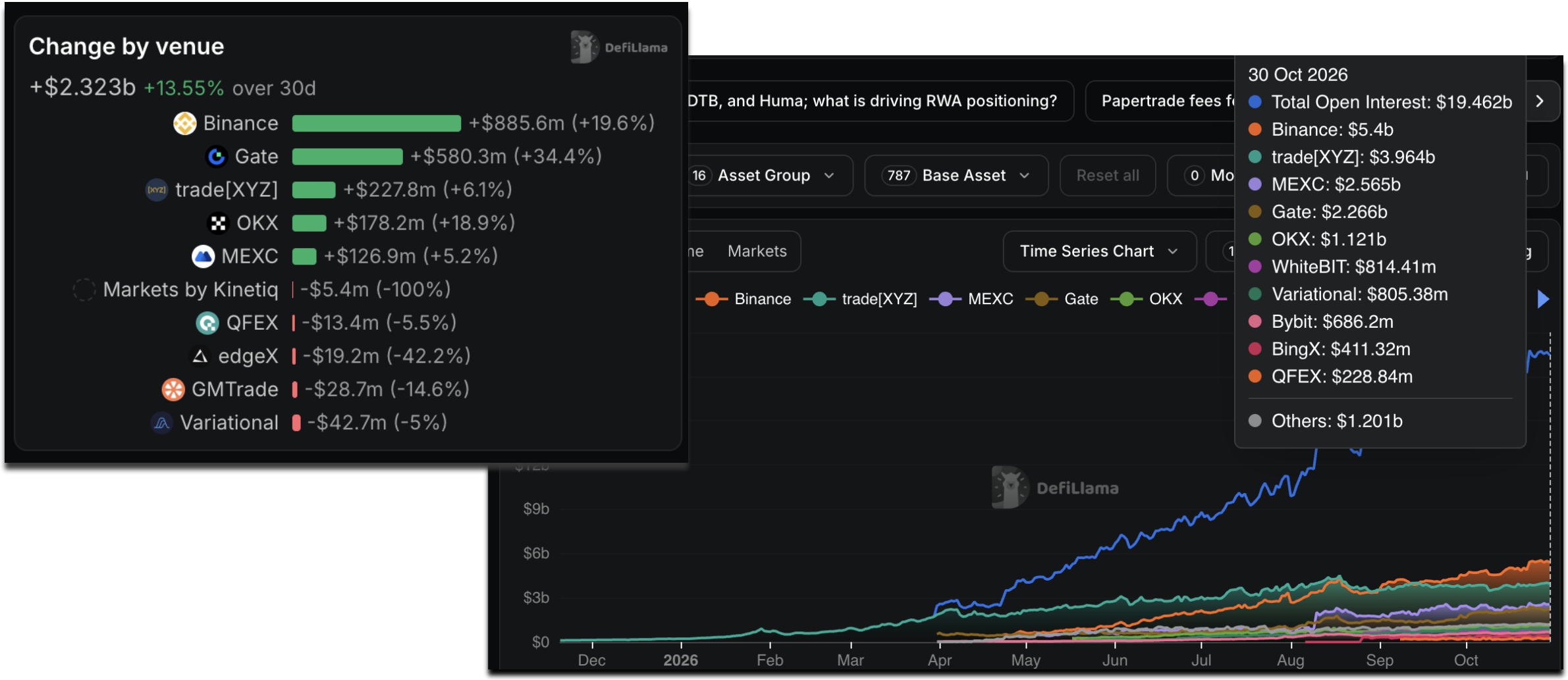


121.3%

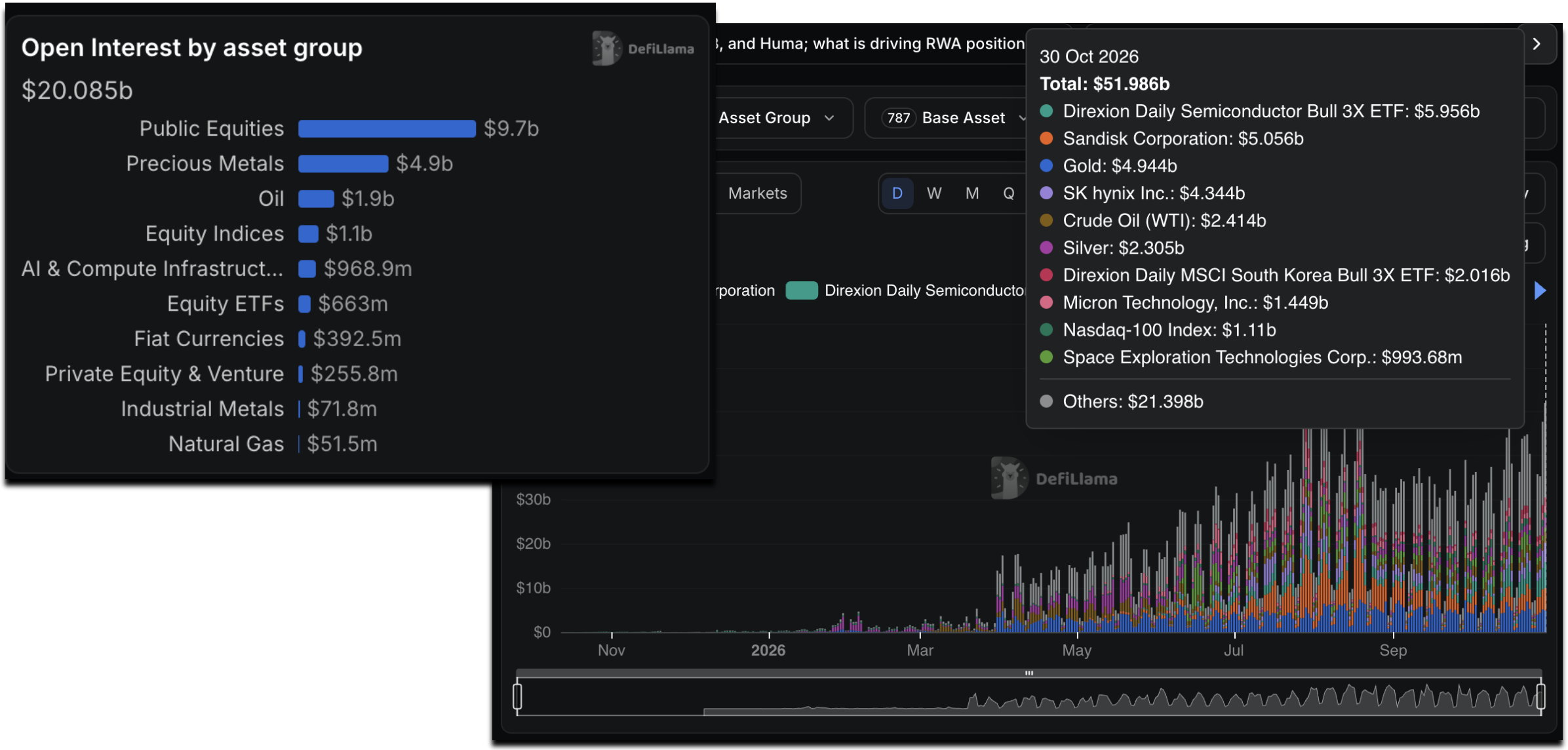
H1-end open interest / spot market cap
Different asset sets. Not a measure of investor capital.

Source: September report p. 20, Figure 13. Hyperliquid equity perps / observed tokenized-equity market cap.

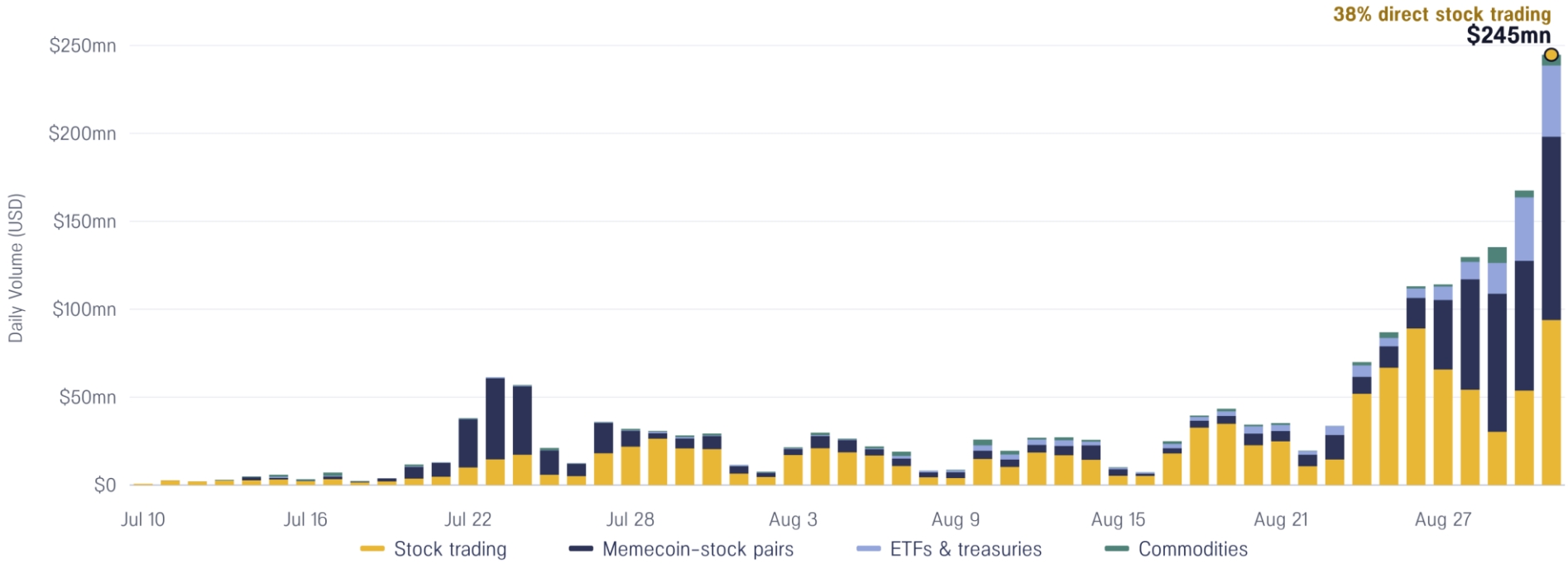
RWA perpetuals: leading venues



RWA perpetuals: most-traded assets



Robinhood: a consumer distribution channel



$5mn → $887.5mn

weekly observed RWA trading

Early distribution can grow faster than economic participation.

Source: September report pp. 3 and 22, Figure 15. Separate post-H1 case study through August 31, 2026.

Adam Aron @CEOAdam · Sep 3

Robinhood apparently is behind an effort related to “tokenized real-world assets including Stock Tokens” for AMC Entertainment (and supposedly 190+ other companies). They are not registered under U.S. securities laws !!!!!!

I find this practice to be contemptible, outrageous,
Show more

docs.robinhood.com
Robinhood RHJ
Issuer and contact information, disclosures, price deviations, and corporate actions for Robinhood ...

1.5K 2.2K 5.3K 2.1M

Vlad Tenev
@vladtenev

What’s the concern?

11:11 PM · Sep 3, 2026 · **3.7M** Views

1.8K 1.7K 9.6K 527

Relevant View quotes

Adam Aron
@CEOAdam

Seriously? What’s the concern you ask, @vladtenev? The list of concerns is almost existential.

U.S. securities laws are in place to protect investors. For good reason, we spend millions and millions of dollars every year to comply with U.S. securities laws. In good. conscience, how can Robinhood as a U.S. company set up an operation in far offshore Jersey, an island 3000 miles away, and market a security sort of posing as AMC in some shape or fashion, and not comply with U.S. securities laws. That is shocking and shameful.

Our past issuance of equity to strengthen our balance sheet was vital to our success. Your setting up some kind of fictitious synthetic equity market decouples stock token ownership from a company’s ability to control its own capital raising efforts.

Share ownership gives shareholders various rights, including the right to vote their shares. Your stock token pretend to be some form of stock ownership, but disclosures to the contrary notwithstanding, they are not ownership and they deprive investors of their rights.

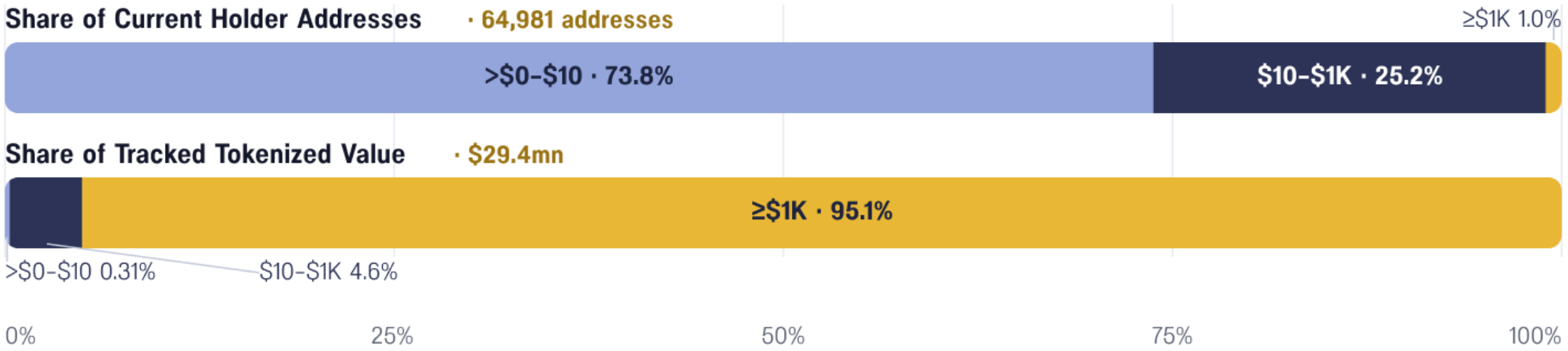
This quasi-fake market you are creating on the island of Jersey sows distrust amongst the public about financial markets in general. There already is distrust in financial institutions, you are potentially making it far worse.

These are but a few of my concerns about your actions.

I hereby call on you and Robinhood to voluntarily CEASE AND DECIST the trading of AMC stock tokens. If you don’t, our high priced securities counsel has been asked to see whether we can force you to stop.

I also wonder how can the SEC possibly support your sham ignoring of U.S. securities laws. You can be sure we will be asking them.

Robinhood: 1% of holder addresses held 95.1% of value



669 addresses

held at least $1,000

86.2%

of July transfers were below $1

Robinhood chain case study. Source: September pp. 23–24. Post-H1 snapshot; address balances are not unique beneficial owners.

Liquidity measures should reflect the asset’s intended use

Product purpose	Investor need	Useful measurements
Hold for yield	Income and access to funds	Redemption timing, fees, eligibility, exit capacity
Trade exposure	Competitive execution	Spreads, executable size, slippage, hours, maker coverage
Pledge collateral	Reliable financing	Haircuts, borrowing capacity, price feeds, liquidation route

Programmable markets need measurable use

Adapted from September report p. 18. Execution quality requires data beyond turnover.

Questions for industry and policy research

Eligible participation	Can approved market makers and venues widen access while preserving the product's transfer rules?
Rights and exits	What claim does the holder own, and who supplies liquidity when trading or redemption is stressed?
Comparable evidence	Which measures reveal execution quality and real participation across spot, perps, and collateral?

Discussion questions derived from the reports' evidence. No causal or legal conclusion implied.

The next phase is market formation

Product architecture	TPI remains 2.04 as the catalog expands
Market access	Open-transfer products dominate observed spot activity
Useful infrastructure	Execution, redemption, or financing, depending on purpose

tokenization.panteracapital.com

Appendix / Measurement boundaries

Lens	Population / period	Key boundary
Market benchmark	$331.8bn at June 30	RWA.xyz series; separate from catalog
Pantera catalog	671 tracked / 598 scored	$320.8bn observed closing value
Spot / distribution	110 products ≥ $10mn	June 2026; non-stablecoins only
Ownership	Addresses and token balances	Beneficial owners are not observed
Robinhood case study	July–August 2026	Excluded from H1 totals

Source: September report pp. 25–32 and 38. Reference periods and populations are distinct.